



the dynasties. The modelling of some wares made in Kangxi Reign might look raw and unsophisticated, but in Yongzheng Reign they were particularly fine and better-looking.

The *Qinghua* porcelains were not very densely decorated, they just imitated the Xuande *Qinghua* porcelain. While the porcelain of *Fencai*, in place of the five-coloured, progressed further: the decorative patterns became softer and the colours became more light and elegant. Painted on the plain background, the enamel colour looked more appealing. The photochromic glazes with single colour were now made with rich gradations such as the pale blue and the sky blue. The decorations included the pictures of ladies, figures and flowers all with elegance, and the inscription mark on the wares "大清雍正年制" (made in Yongzheng Reign of the Great Qing) was written in the style of Song typeface and seal script.

QIANLONG REIGN Porcelains at the time became more stylish and colourful, with patterns of extreme complexity. Unprecedented special types of porcelains were also produced with amazingly high virtuosity.

Emperor Qianlong's keen interests in porcelains had a great influence on the production in the Imperial Factory, and gave a shot in the arm to the innovation in porcelain industry. To cater for the royal needs, the Imperial Factory experimented and produced new types of porcelains, making possible the emergence of some uniquely-designed varieties and modelling types of porcelains. They made further progress in the *Fencai* and the enamel-coloured wares. Still, the wares were designed by royal artists before the Imperial Factory produced them accordingly.

During this period, the *Fencai* decoration was not only largely attached to white ground, but also used on multi-colour ground. Some *Fencai* patterns were painted on the panels, or on the multi-coloured grounds, achieving the effects of the enamel wares with copper body. The decorative technique of rolling on the multicoloured ground, beginning at Yongzheng Reign, was used to produce wares in quantity. The decorations of the upper and lower parts of some wares imitated the patterns of the wire-inlaid enamelware. Their belly parts were decorated with *Fencai* patterns, or panelled landscapes and figures, or poems written by the Emperor. They were all very creative. Even the large-sized wares, such as *Zun* and large vase, were all very beautiful. The enamel colour decoration borrowed the meticulous techniques of Western oil-paintings to paint plumes, flowers and landscapes and objects, with stereoscopic effects. They generally depicted traditional

patterns symbolising auspicious matters, and also described Western people and scenery.

Since Yongzheng Reign, imitating the glaze colours of the five famous kilns in the Song Dynasty had been in the vogue. And porcelain variety was in great quantity. Then the producers began to imitate the special glaze-like colours and decoration effects of the matters such as jade, ancient bronze, lacquer wares, the mother-of-pearl-inlaid, rattan works, bamboo ware, woodenware, gourd ware, and the ware with incised patterns filled with gold and silver colours. The bronze-coloured *Zun*, for example, was imitated not only in terms of modelling and glaze colours, but also of effects with inlaying gold and silver on the ware. Other imitations, such as the porcelain with modelling imitating animals and plants, were also very close to the original. They employed high techniques including carving, engraving and openwork to produce the openwork revolving vases and openwork revolving neck vases. The large *Zun* named *Cimu* (Mother Porcelain), which infused different techniques such as *Fencai*, colour glazing, and *Qinghua* engraving, was a fantastic masterpiece.

The modelling of the wares was very formal, with multi-sized modelling carefully made. The styles were generally resplendent and creative. Stationary and display porcelains prevailed. The decorative patterns boasted a wide-range of themes. Apart from the traditional ones, the bulk of the patterns were both the pictures with connotations of traditional moral and the pictures of auspicious objects which symbolised longevity, wealth and good fortune, for example, the bat (*Fu*) pattern symbolised the "good fortune" because it had the same pronunciation as the character "福" (good fortune). Also there were patterns glorifying peace and stability. The inscription marks were written in the style of seal script.